

the match from the gallery. I told the attendant to go and tell him that I was playing, not him," Ganguly said, adding, "After an hour, I told John, let's take the risk and we declared the innings.

"Even at Lunch, Steve Waugh was batting and I was still not sure about a win. But we got Steve after Tea, then Venky (Raju) got Mark Waugh, and then I brought Sachin Tendulkar in. He got a couple of wickets and that's when we started believing that we could win."

Ganguly also recollected the incident when he made Steve wait at the toss. "I was under pressure, so I forgot to wear the blazer at the toss, and Steve had to wait. I looked at his expression and he was clearly not happy. Later, we used it as a strategy," Ganguly said, adding that back then he did not know that his team would create history.

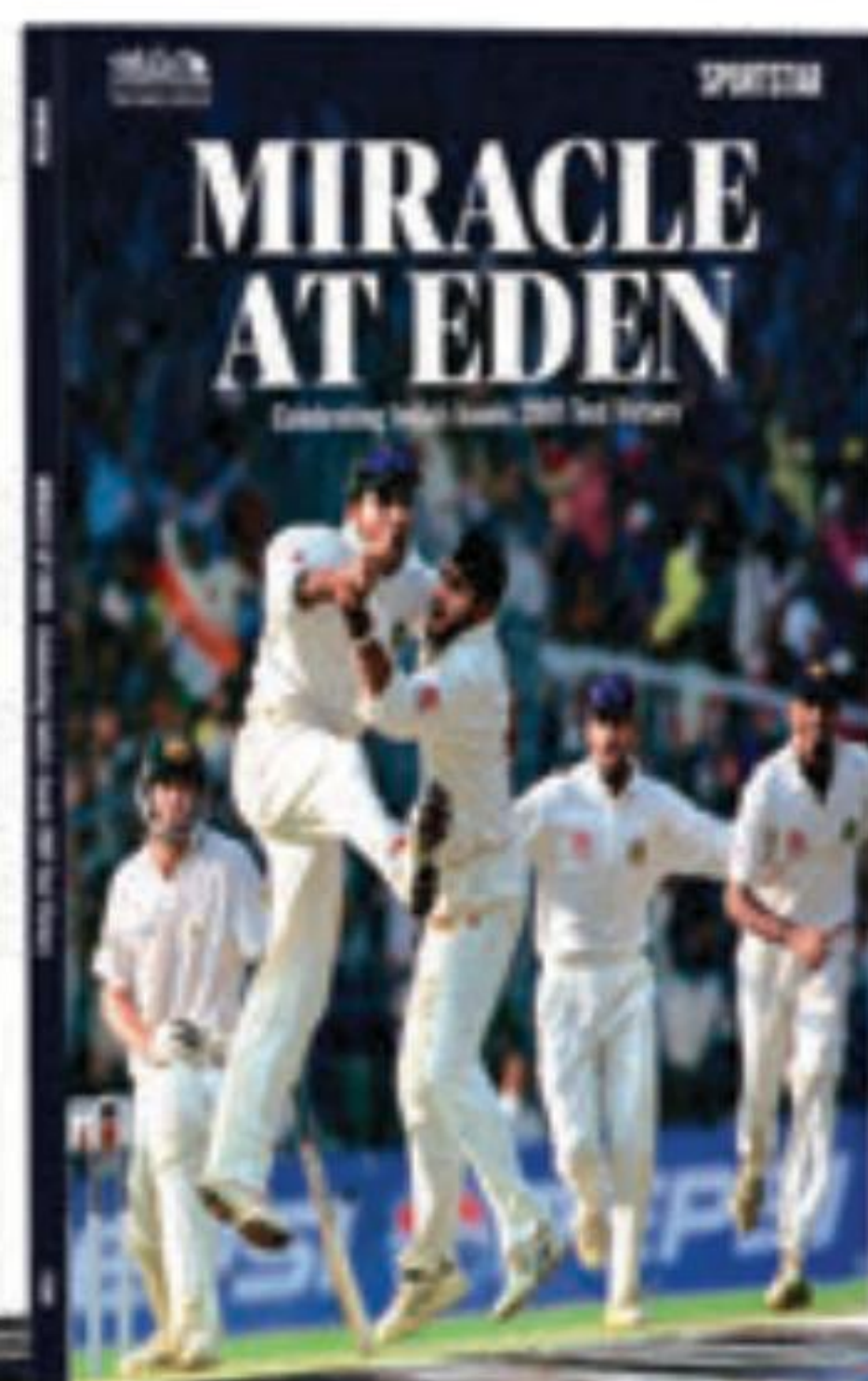
"The name of the book is apt. It, indeed, was a miracle at Eden," Ganguly said.

A lesson in management

Speaking at the launch of the book, Ravindra Rai M, MD and CEO BOBCARD Ltd., said: "Having played the game and now working at the management level, I see this as more than just a game of cricket. It is a lesson in management. This is a case study that could be presented to any management student or professional as an example of how to lead and manage a team. I believe belief is the most important thing. Belief is often the first casualty in times of uncertainty, but that is what this team held on to. And it is because of that belief that we are here today, celebrating 25 years of that remarkable achievement."



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Ganguly backs BCCI's stadium rotation policy even as Eden Gardens misses out on India vs Australia Test



Ganguly, who is currently the president of Cricket Association of Bengal (CAB), backed the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI)'s rotation policy even as Eden Gardens and the Wankhede Stadium missed out on hosting any of the five Tests of the Border-Gavaskar Trophy, which will end a busy 2026-27 home season for India.

"It's always great to have big Test matches back at Eden Gardens. As the president of the CAB and being a former player, I would like to host Test matches here, but we got the Test against South Africa, then there were T20 World Cup games and the Indian Premier League fixtures," Ganguly said. "But stadiums all around India are very good. I am so happy to see a Test match in Chennai. Then there are matches in Guwahati and Ranchi, where the facilities are very good. As much as you would like to host matches at the Eden, it is important to understand that it has to go to other venues as well," Ganguly said.

Venkatapathy Raju, however, spoke in favour of the traditional Test venues hosting games. "Back in our time, we had five Test venues — Kolkata, Kanpur, Chennai, Delhi, Mumbai — and it had its own charm. I think they should go back to that format again," Raju said.

"Hosting T20Is and ODIs are alright, but playing in these five Test centres is always special. Playing at a venue like Eden is always a privilege, because of the huge crowd support."



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